

Rory Hart

PRODUCT DESIGN LEADER • MENTOR • STRATEGIST

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SUMMARY

Enthusiastic and highly driven design team leader, systems-level design thinker, and visionary - with over 15 years of hands-on experience, strong instincts, and outstanding intuition. With a strong penchant for clean design, I am a relentless advocate for the user, and am committed to leading teams to create elegant and simple user experiences from otherwise complex workflows. I take the time to not only understand the whole design but the critical components and goals of the business to build world-class products.

EXPERIENCE

Yahoo Finance, Mountain View — Director, Head of *Product Design*

APR 2023 - PRESENT

Demonstrated exceptional leadership and collaboration skills by effectively managing a team of mid-level to senior principal product designers. Partnering with executive leadership and cross-functional partners to lead working sessions, facilitate workshops, set strategy, and prioritize the roadmap, culminating in the successful rollout of the Yahoo Finance redesign. Major achievements include shipping significant product redesigns such as your Portfolio, Company (Quote) pages, and Markets & Research Hubs. My proactive approach and ability to navigate complex projects and team dynamics have resulted in substantial contributions to delivering quality products across web, mobile web, and native platforms.

Lark Health, Mountain View — Director, *Head of Design & UX Research*

APR 2021 - April 2023

Scaling a design organization from the ground up that comprises of 4 core pillars - Product Design, Brand Design, Content Design, and UX Research. I promote a world-class design thinking practice within Lark Health's greater organization; influence product strategy and vision; ensure product execution; and deliver quality products and features to our users. As a Design Leader, I support managers, designers and researchers with rapid prototypes of concepts and ideas, provide coaching, mentorship, and champion my team's craft and career development, while creating a safe haven so they can accomplish their best work and deliver quality user experiences.

Hulu, Santa Monica — *Sr. Manager, Product Design*

SEPT 2020 - APR 2021

Strategy & Vision

Leading role in creating the desired future state and experience for Hulu's personalized features such as Onboarding, My Stuff, bookmarking, Recordings/DVR, engagement actions on content and notifications. This led to some amazing innovative work from the team that has helped drive our subscriber growth from 11 Million to 30+ Million in 2020.

Leadership, Mentorship & Coaching

Ability to bring the best out of designers - With a heavy focus on building strong relationships and giving the designers clear direction, ownership, and focus areas, they have been able to grow as leaders on their respective platforms.

Team Culture

I built a unique team culture that thrives on collaboration, strategy, and innovation. Every designer brought a unique set of skills to the team which allowed us to cover many surface areas of the product and its device offerings.

Effective Management & Hiring Experience

Through getting to know the designers on my team personally, and understanding their aspirations and goals through regular 1:1's, I have been able to adapt to each designer's wants and needs. This has enabled me to identify gaps in expertise needed for the team to be successful which led to building a well-rounded, strong collaborative team.

Design Operations

Lead all efforts to streamline our design process and integrate design-thinking tools such as MURAL and Experience Fellow. MURAL is now one of the core design tools within the product design team that allows us to facilitate workshops internally, across states, and the globe.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Scaling Design Organizations
Lead & Mentor UX Teams
Rapid Prototyping
Wireframing
Design Thinking Facilitator: Workshops
Human-Centered Design
Behavioral Change: Engagement
Build Cultures of Innovation
Stakeholder Alignment
User Research
Data Visualization
Omni-Channel Experiences
Machine Learning/AI Design Strategy
Conversation Design/AIUX

TOOLS

Figma/FigJam
MURAL
Slack
Usertesting.com
Dscout

GOOD UNDERSTANDING OF:

Design Thinking Methods
Retention Strategies
Immersive Media (AR/VR)
Design Systems

EDUCATION

Northumbria University,
Newcastle, UK - 2003-2005
Foundation Degree
Data Visualization & Media Design

Hulu, Santa Monica — *Manager, Product Design*

JAN 2018 - SEPT 2020

- Built out the personalization design team focusing on engagement features across Hulu's suite of products and services
- Oversaw the UX for the offline downloads feature that launched on both iOS and android
- Partnered with product, engineering leads to deliver the design direction for the social watch party feature

Hulu, Santa Monica — *Senior UX Designer*

MAY 2016 - JAN 2018

- Design lead responsible for delivering My Stuff & Cloud DVR UX for the Hulu live product across mobile, web and living room devices
- Introduced iterative user testing and prototyping best practices alongside the user research team

Transamerica, Los Angeles — *UX Design Lead*

AUGUST 2014 - MAY 2016

- Lead the efforts for mobile strategy for Transamerica products by educating enterprise stakeholders about how to best leverage mobile capabilities to meet their business goals and customer needs
- Created the first portable full 360° mobile usability research lab
- Successfully launched the first fully responsive insurance website within Transamerica
- Assisted cross divisional teams in ideation exercises to push the boundaries of mobile design
- implemented successful strategies that significantly enhanced Transamerica's capabilities for consumers who wished to interact with Transamerica through their mobile devices

Transamerica, Los Angeles — *UX Designer*

SEPTEMBER 2013 -AUGUST 2014

- Developed effective interactive design solutions that met business, project, and design goals, based on standards and guidelines
- Ideation Activities (e.g. Mind Mapping, Journey Mapping, Data Modeling, Persona and Goal Task Analysis exercises). Conducted over 150 hours of UX Workshops
- Interaction Design Best Practices - standardized wireframe templates and artifacts that are currently being used by all individual contributors

ASCII Media Inc., Los Angeles — *Sr. UI Designer*

APRIL 2013 - SEPTEMBER 2013

- Created IA and user experience documentation and contributed to the development of processes and best practices by developing detailed navigation flows, sitemaps, wireframes, and interface design/functional specifications

Telegraph Media Group, London — Designer

AUGUST 2010 - FEBRUARY 2013

Wall Street Journal Europe, London — *Graphics Editor*

SEPTEMBER 2009 - AUGUST 2010

The Guardian, London — *Designer*

AUGUST 2009 - SEPTEMBER 2009

BBC News, London — *Online Designer*

AUGUST 2005 - OCTOBER 2008

WORKSHOPS & MENTORSHIP

UXSC Prototyping Workshop

University of Southern California, Los Angeles 2016

UXSC Service Design Hackathon

University Southern California, Los Angeles 2016

UX Portfolio Review & Mentorship

General Assembly, Los Angeles 2017

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Video Games

Football (Soccer)

Sound Engineering

Movies & Documentaries

Travel

New Restaurants

Going to Gigs & Festivals

Reading Design Books

Emerging technologies

Design Conferences

Blockchain Tech/Crypto